

- **Address legal and regulatory issues:** As a starting point, an effective strategy should address the local, national and international legislation regarding confidentiality and integrity of customer, financial and employee data.
- **Minimise strain on computing resources:** The software should provide comprehensive protection against a variety of threats without consuming significant bandwidth or operating resources on servers and client computers.
- **Decrease end user interaction:** Pest-prevention software should operate transparently so that employees cannot bypass or disable the protection.
- **Reduce IT overhead:** To free IT staff to focus on more strategic projects, the software should offer automatic deployment, trickledown updates and centralised reporting and management.
- **Enable flexible file handling:** Because there may be legitimate business uses for potentially suspect applications, such as file-sharing programs and network packet sniffers, administrators should be able to make case-by-case decisions about which kinds of tools may be allowed in specific circumstances.
- **Support the improvement of company-wide protection:** The protection software should offer comprehensive event-logging capabilities so that administrators can spot trends and update acceptable use policies and firewall configurations accordingly.